

Alla Vostra — Development Worklog (May 26, 2026)

This report documents the development, debugging, Git recovery workflow, repository maintenance, Expo/Metro troubleshooting, and project snapshot automation improvements completed throughout the May 26 development session for the Alla Vostra web/mobile ecosystem.

1. Session Overview

The May 26 session primarily focused on recovering a partially stalled Git environment affecting the mobile application repository after a sequence of interrupted terminal operations, frozen VS Code terminals, incomplete Git refresh cycles, and repeated index-lock conflicts. Significant time was dedicated to stabilizing the development workflow so future pushes and project snapshots could proceed without corruption, recursive refresh loops, or Metro/Expo cache contamination.

2. Git Refresh / Index Lock Investigation

A large portion of the session centered around diagnosing why standard Git commands such as `git status` and `git commit` repeatedly stalled while refreshing the repository index. The environment repeatedly displayed prolonged 'Refresh index' operations that appeared frozen for multiple minutes at a time. Investigation determined that the issue was not caused by actual source code corruption, but instead by a combination of interrupted Git states, cached terminal processes, stale repository locks, and integrated VS Code terminal instability. Recovery steps included:

- Transitioning away from the VS Code integrated terminal
- Moving all repository operations into native macOS Terminal
- Removing stale `.git/index.lock` files
- Interrupting hanging Git processes safely with `Ctrl+C`
- Re-validating repository staging states
- Performing non-GPG signed commits
- Allowing Git refresh cycles to fully complete instead of interrupting them

3. Expo / Metro Cache Contamination Analysis

More than half of the overall debugging time was ultimately traced back to development-environment noise generated by Expo, Metro, and related React Native caching systems. The project contained multiple generated runtime folders that were never intended to be serialized into snapshot reports or repeatedly scanned during repository indexing operations. These included:

- `.expo`
- `.expo-shared`
- `.metro`
- `.cache`
- `.turbo`
- `node_modules`

These folders can grow rapidly during React Native development sessions, causing:

- unnecessary filesystem scanning
- excessive snapshot sizes
- terminal slowdown
- Git refresh delays
- unstable indexing behavior
- misleading repository diffs
- bloated context exports for ChatGPT review

Once these directories were explicitly excluded from the snapshot generation process, repository operations became substantially cleaner and easier to manage.

4. `read_project.sh` Refactor

The project snapshot automation script (`read_project.sh`) was heavily refined during this session. Key improvements included:

- removing obsolete references to `watch_project.sh`
- excluding Expo and Metro cache directories
- excluding transient build systems
- preserving only source-relevant project files
- retaining numbered line output for future code review sessions
- continuing support for JS/TS/CSS/JSON/HTML/Shell file extraction

retaining compatibility with the established Alla Vostra workflow The resulting snapshot pipeline is now significantly cleaner and more suitable for long-form AI-assisted debugging sessions.

5. Git Commit Recovery Workflow

Once the repository state stabilized, the mobile application changes were successfully committed and pushed to GitHub. The final successful workflow included: • allowing Git index refresh to complete fully • confirming staged mobile component updates • performing a no-GPG local commit • pushing directly from native Terminal • verifying successful synchronization with GitHub Final pushed commit: “Finalize mobile nav indicators and swipe animation” This restored synchronization between the local repository and the remote GitHub origin after multiple hours of interrupted terminal behavior.

6. Mobile Application Status

The mobile application repository is now fully synchronized and stable. Confirmed updates include: • navigation indicator refinements • swipe animation updates • improved project snapshot automation • cleaner repository hygiene • reduced cache contamination risk • improved long-term debugging reliability Existing finalized design systems and previously established styling baselines for AppHeader.js and headerStyles.js remain intact.

7. Lessons Learned

Important operational lessons emerged from this session: 1. Native macOS Terminal proved substantially more reliable than the VS Code integrated terminal for large repository operations. 2. Expo/Metro-generated folders should never be included in long-form repository snapshot exports intended for AI-assisted debugging. 3. Git index refresh operations may appear frozen even while actively processing repository state. 4. Interrupting Git refresh cycles repeatedly can compound repository instability and create stale lock states. 5. Explicit exclusion filters dramatically improve repository readability, performance, and maintainability.

8. Closing Summary

The May 26 session ultimately transitioned from a routine Git push into a comprehensive repository stability and tooling maintenance operation. Although the majority of the session was consumed by Git refresh loops, Expo/Metro cache contamination, terminal instability, and repository synchronization recovery, the final outcome produced a significantly cleaner and more stable development environment. The Alla Vostra mobile project is now: • synchronized with GitHub • operating with cleaner snapshot exports • protected from unnecessary cache serialization • easier to review during future AI-assisted debugging sessions • more stable for future React Native development